

New Macbook

Apple has updated the Macbook with NVIDIA GeForce 320M graphics processor and an 10 hr battery backup

iPhone as credit card?

VISA has announced a contactless payment system for the iPhone through a payment system called "In2pay" which allows you to use the phone as a credit card

Bazaar

TAG Z-626

Good looks, poor performance

The TAG-626 headphones appear like a custom made set of headphones from BMW car company thanks to the tacky imitation of the BMW logo on the outer end of the ear cups. It is a supra-aural headphone, which means that the headphone will rest on your ear rather than cover it. The blue/white colour scheme continues on the head band as well which provides a good grip, such that it won't fall off if you are jogging with these headphones on.

Earcup covering is made up of poor quality plastic. The foam padding is decent, but not very comfortable as it tends to press onto the earlobes. There's

a small volume controller on the left hand side. A microphone is connected to the left hand earcup with the help of a flexible wire. The wire provided is long enough.

Performance wise TAG-626 is disappointing. Low frequency response is quite bad as there is hardly any bass effect. The sound output is quite flat. The headphone not very successful at distinguishing sounds with minute details like rain drops, coins clinking as well as low intensity sounds. The head-



phone has a tendency to mix up these sounds. The mids and higher frequencies sound satisfactory. Sound separation was good though.

It's priced at a very economical Rs. 499 so go for it, if you are not looking at sound quality.

Specifications

Sensitivity : -106 dB+/- 3 dB; Impedance : 32 Ohms; 3.5 mm audio jack; Cord Length : less than 2.5 mtrs

Contact

Technology and Gadgets
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Web site: www.technologyandgadgets.com
Price: Rs. 499

5/10

Build Quality.....	4
Features.....	5
Performance.....	5
Value for money.....	5

AMD Phenom II X6 1090T Black Edition

Hexa-core!

Specifications

Clock frequency : 3.2 GHz; TDP : 125 W; 45 nm process technology; 938 micro Pin Grid Array; Socket : AM3 and AM2+

Contact

AMD
Phone: 1800 425 6664
Email: fusion.india@amd.com
Web site: www.amd.com
Price: Rs. 15,999

Turbo Core technology that, when activated, boosts the clock speed of three cores upto 3.6 GHz while running a workload that would leave some cores idle. The 1090T is based on a 45-nm silicon on insulator technology and has the same 6 MB shared L3 cache as the X4 965.

We tested this board on an Asus Crosshair IV Formula motherboard which houses AMD's latest 890FX chipset having an AM3 socket. The X6 1090T is compatible with AM2+ and AM3 sockets. We



used a Sparkle GTX 285 card, Corsair 4GB DDR3 RAM@1333 MHz and an 1100W Cooler Master power supply. Performance wise it's nowhere close to Intel's Gulftown hexa core processor. It gave a Cinebench Multithreaded score of 14,457 which was much less than the 21,000 plus score we got on an Intel Core i7 980X. Unlike the 980X, the 1090T does not support hyper threading. The overall 3D Mark Vantage score was 44,664. It took 31 seconds for a 100 MB video encoding. Gaming scores were quite good

also with Crysis (Crytek Island, 1024 x 768, low quality) giving 116 frames per second, Company of Heroes : Tales of Valor (1280x1024, low quality) giving 85 fps.

Priced at Rs. 15,999, this processor is ideal for enthusiast users who want a great performance without having to pay through the nose. Compared to i7 980X, the 1090T gives two thirds of the performance but at a price point so economical, it is a great buy for anyone looking at purchasing a 6-core processor.

7/10

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Features.....	6
Performance.....	6.5
Value for Money.....	7.5